



September 2026

CONTINUAL
PROFESSIONAL
DEVELOPMENT

Welcome to the latest edition of the FPG monthly round-up newsletter covering everything you need to know, including recent industry updates, risk news, mortgage and protection updates and some performance figures.

We hope you all had an enjoyable summer whether than included managing school holidays or not! Whilst the summer holidays season did have its usual effect of being slightly quieter than the months preceding it the wider FPG network still submitted over £156m in lending and completed on over £194m which is showing how much of the earlier year efforts continue to pay off.

The next big event for FPG is our summer conference on 11th September. At the event we will be hearing some updates from our hosts Nationwide but also the management team at FPG have some exciting updates for you across a topics including marketing, tech, AI and business referral options. We look forward to seeing as many of you there as possible.

Your FPG team are on hand for anything you need so please get in touch with anything we can help with.

Thank you.

David

Compliance News 12/08 (Mortgage Advice Standards)

We have updated our Mortgage Advice Standards, and you should all be familiar with the content of this document.

(Our Protection Advice Standards will also be updated within the next few weeks.).

Compliance News 13/08 (PMS APEX Protection Panel)

For those of you who take indemnity commission (up front) then there will be an uplift to the commission rates for a few insurers, but at the expense of renewal commission. No action is needed by Advisers as the systems will simply update themselves. There are no changes at all for Advisers who take non-indemnity commission (on-the-drip).

Recent Complaints

In the last three months we have received the following 4 new complaints, and we are sharing details of these to hopefully avoid future occurrences:

1. **Mr S.** We applied for both a re-mortgage and a product transfer on the same case, and with both completing the client was being charged an ERC to redeem the PT.

There were justifiable reasons for doing both applications, with the PT being arranged because the re-mortgage didn't look like it was proceeding, thus preventing a month on SVR. However, both mortgages actually completed and, as the advice firm, we should have prevented one of these from happening.

Complaint upheld. No financial payment, but we persuaded the PT lender to undo the mortgage and refund the first mortgage payment to the client. No ERC payable.

Key learning. We need to be closer to cases such as these to ensure that one of the mortgages is cancelled before completion.
2. **Mrs S.** We arranged a further advance lifetime mortgage for this client who was unhappy about not knowing which part of her mortgage to overpay on.

Whilst the written explanation from the Adviser to the client appeared very clear, a telephone call to the client to explain things verbally was all that was needed to appease this client. A simplified explanation was then put in writing to the client who replied confirming she understood what to do.

Complaint refuted. We had told the client exactly what to do, but she was elderly and a little confused.

Key learning. Individuals have different ways of understanding and perhaps offering a conversation instead of an email might have helped this client's understanding.
3. **Mr C.** Concerned about a data breach because he has been passed from a retired Adviser to a new Adviser trading under a different trading name.

An Adviser had retired, and her clients were being passed to another Adviser. The new Adviser was never introduced to the client by the retiring Adviser, hence the confusion.

Complaint refuted. Explanation to the client how both trading names are FPG and a reassurance that there is no data breach.

Key learning. When transferring clients from one Adviser to another, in whatever situation, best practice is that the new Adviser needs a proper introduction.

4. Mr W. Complaint concerning a GDPR breach.

We accidentally mis-typed an email address onto a lender's application in their portal. It was a product transfer, and the lender immediately emailed the mortgage offer to Mrs (correctly) but not to Mr because the email address was wrong. The amount of personal information in the mortgage offer actually makes this a low-level breach, but it has still been reported to the ICO because of the distress presented by the client.

Complaint upheld. It is a simple human error, but we ultimately made the mistake. We have paid for the clients to have Cifas protection for 2 years, plus Experian Identity Plus for 1 year. The client is also negotiating further compensation.

Key learning. We simply need to take time to check and double check our data entry, especially email addresses, as more and more lenders (and insurers) are using email as a communication method with their customers.

Some other GDPR best practices

Following the recent data breach, here are just a few best practice processes to avoid emails being sent to the wrong recipient, or keyed incorrectly.

1. Make this a simple mandatory habit: STOP – CHECK – SEND
 - a. STOP: Don't send immediately after composing the email
 - b. CHECK: Check the recipient's name, email address and the information being sent
 - c. SEND: Only send once you are satisfied it is going to the intended person
2. When in outlook, wherever possible, always reply (or reply all if applicable) to existing email threads to avoid an incorrect recipient being selected
3. Include the client surname in the email subject as it will make it easier to spot if the wrong email address or attachment has been selected
4. Use the Acre client portal, or Whats App, to communicate instead of email
5. Remember that external emails cannot be recalled

Non-Financial Misconduct (NFM)

From 1st September, non-financial misconduct (NFM) became subject to the FCA's Conduct Rules requirements.

NFM covers conduct that violates an individual's dignity, creates an intimidating, hostile, degrading, humiliating or offensive environment for that individual, or involves actual physical violence.

These rules are aimed at addressing poor behaviour between individuals in the workplace. This is because the FCA's existing Conduct Rules (a reminder of which is provided below) already cover such matters where customers are involved. For example, Conduct Rule 1 requires individuals to act with integrity. These changes are therefore specifically aimed at addressing a gap in the rules relating to behaviour between individuals in the workplace.

Clearly, behaviour such as sexual harassment or an unprovoked physical assault is likely to meet the threshold for a breach of the Conduct Rules and could result in disciplinary action. However, other behaviour that may be less obvious can also amount to non-financial misconduct where it affects another individual's dignity or wellbeing or creates an intimidating, hostile, degrading, humiliating or offensive environment.

This applies to all staff covered by the FCA's Conduct Rules, whether you work in an administrative or office-based role, are senior managers, employed advisers, self-employed advisers, or hold any other role subject to the rules. It can also apply to conduct both within the workplace and outside it, including at social events organised by FPG or by your firm.

You are reminded that, at all times, you are required to comply with the following Individual Conduct Rules:

The 5 First Tier Individual Conduct Rules, plus the Consumer Duty Conduct Rule	
1.	You must act with integrity
2.	You must act with due care, skill and diligence
3.	You must be open and cooperative with the FCA, the PRA and other Regulators
4.	You must pay due regard to the interests of customers and treat them fairly
5.	You must observe proper standards of market conduct
CD.	You must act to deliver good outcomes for all retail customers

Any concerns of non-financial misconduct should be reported to your line manager or another senior manager with whom you are comfortable discussing the matter.

Lead Providers must be approved

Where you are looking to take leads from a lead provider, that firm must be approved by FPG in the first instance. This is because it is important for us to understand whether the lead provider is regulated by the FCA, and what the customer journey looks like, for instance are their adverts and landing page compliant. If you provide details of any lead provider we can carry out these checks for you. We can also let you know of any lead providers who have been approved, or not.

CPD reminder

Just a reminder that as we are now, somehow, in September already, you should all now be close to having 12 hours of mortgage CPD recorded on your CPD Logs, plus at least 12 hours of insurance CPD too. And where you hold an additional licence for Lifetime Mortgages, Specialist Lending, PMI or Business Protection then you should be recording CPD in these licence areas too.

protectionnews

AUGUST:

One of our advisers recently saw first-hand why putting Life Cover in Trust can be so important. A client sadly passed away unexpectedly, leaving behind his partner and two young children. Thankfully, the client's Life Cover had been written in trust, meaning the claim could be paid directly to the intended beneficiaries rather than becoming part of his estate. The money was made available to his partner much sooner, providing immediate financial support to help with the mortgage, household bills and the costs of looking after their children at an incredibly difficult time. It's a simple step that can easily be overlooked when arranging protection, but in a family crisis, having the money reach the right people as quickly as possible can make a huge difference.

Vitality – Pick and Play Continues to Change the Rewards Game

Vitality's new Pick and Play programme gives members more choice over the rewards they can work towards, with the aim of making the Vitality Programme more engaging and relevant to individual members. It's a useful reminder for advisers that Vitality's proposition is evolving beyond simply offering discounts, with greater personalisation built into the rewards experience.

👉 [Vitality Adviser](#) ([Vitality Insurance Plans](#))

Royal London – Income Protection Growth Highlights the Opportunity

Royal London has reported that its UK protection new business increased 6% in the first half of 2026, with the growth partly attributed to enhancements to its Income Protection proposition. With IP applications continuing to grow across the market, it's a useful prompt to revisit the income conversation with mortgage clients — particularly those relying heavily on their salary to maintain their lifestyle and mortgage.

👉 [Royal London Adviser Protection](#) ([Royal London](#))

The Exeter – £71m Paid in Claims During 2025

The Exeter has highlighted its 2025 claims figures, paying more than £71m across health, income protection and life insurance. Income Protection accounted for £14m, with 93% of new IP claims paid, while the average age of an Income First claimant was just 37. A useful reminder that income protection isn't just something to think about later in life — it can be hugely relevant to younger mortgage clients too.

👉 [The Exeter – 2025 Claims Statistics](#)

mortgagenews

The main theme of the month was lots of re-pricing from several different lenders with very few specific criteria updates.

Coventry Building Society & The Co-operative Bank

Coventry have now confirmed their intention to transfer Co-operative Bank mortgage customers to Coventry, they will be writing to clients shortly to confirm the change and the implications but it is worth us being aware of the changes should we get any of clients asking questions. You can find more information on the changes here <https://www.intermediary.co-operativebank.co.uk/news/coventry-transfer/#broker-faqs-pdf>.

HSBC

They have made enhancements to their maximum loan amounts across a range of LTV bands

New maximum loan and LTV limits – Houses**			
Loan amount	Max. LTV Capital repayment	Max. LTV Interest only	Max. overall LTV (Part and part)
Up to £570,000	95%***	75%	85%
Up to £775,000	90%	75%	85%
£775,000 to £3 million	85%	75%	85%
£3 million to £5 million	75%	65%	75%
Over £5 million	70%	65%	70%

**Please note, the above changes only apply to houses and there are no changes to the current lending limits for flats.

***The maximum LTV for a Remortgage is 90%.

Proc Fee Payment Route

Please do NOT select PMS when applying for a mortgage. Please always select L&G Mortgage Cub, as we always have. (For your information, PMS are our protection service provider – Zenith PMS.)

performance

Mortgages – Adviser League Table for August 2026

Congratulations to **Rob Chart** for topping our mortgage table for last month.

<u>Adviser</u>	<u>Cases</u>
Rob Chart	27
Phil Smith	21
Andy Poustie	20
Dan Fletcher	20
Jonathan Peachey	20
Jim Maye	18
Jack Humphries	15
Paul Goodey	15
Alex Strange	14
Carl Thorne	13
Emily Chattaway	13
Hannah Logan-Hughes	13
Joanne Pope	13
Cathy Rafferty	12
Claire Lipscomb	12
Paul Gent	12
Paul Ripley	12
Amit Swar	11
Colin Mackay	11
Jack Savory	11
Joe White	11
Peter Stickley	11
Karen Mills	10
Tim Dock	10

Protection (protection and GI combined) – Adviser League Table for August 2026

Congratulations to **Paul Gent** for topping the protection table for last month.

<u>Adviser</u>	<u>Cases</u>
Paul Gent	33
Richard Lucy	22
Clare Mann	21
Andy Poustie	15
Hannah Logan-Hughes	14
Adam Kowalczyk	13
Paul Ripley	13
Bryce Protheroe	13

Rob Chart	12
Jane Hutchinson	10

Congratulations to everyone who has featured on last month's league tables.



Well done to the following advisers who have all submitted million-pound cases so far.

Mortgage cases

Oscar Delves	£2,082,198
Oliver Cunningham	£2,025,000
Hannah Logan-Hughes	£1,977,095
Paul Goodey	£1,564,486
Jim Maye	£1,560,101
Rob Chart	£1,419,142
Hannah Logan-Hughes	£1,400,000
Paul Goodey	£1,370,000
Cathy Rafferty	£1,300,000
Oliver Cunningham	£1,275,646
Paul Goodey	£1,210,000
Cathy Rafferty	£1,196,680
Wilma Scott	£1,158,035
Jim Maye	£1,153,379
Jim Maye	£1,143,008
Cathy Rafferty	£1,135,868
Tracey Copeland	£1,123,000
Paul Goodey	£1,117,500
Cathy Rafferty	£1,112,151
Tony Hornby	£1,105,899
Paul Goodey	£1,099,999
Jim Maye	£1,088,000
Jonathan Peachey	£1,085,950
Paul Goodey	£1,066,449
Karen Mills	£1,025,000
Oliver Cunningham	£1,020,000
Phil Smith	£1,015,000
Rob Chart	£1,007,671

Protection cases

Simon Harris	£1,800,000
Paul Gent	£1,500,000
Karen Mills	£1,471,152

Karen Mills	£1,441,998
Paul Gent	£1,250,000
Paul Ripley	£1,045,998

If you have submitted a policy of £1m or over, or a group of policies to the same client which add up to over £1m, please let me know.



FPG Anniversaries

A big thank you to everyone listed below for your hard work and dedication for however long you've been with us.

- Chris Bartrip – 23 years
- Dan Fletcher – 21 years
- Angela Yeats – 20 years
- Jane Hutchinson – 19 years
- Paul Goodey – 16 years
- Dave Jacob – 13 years
- Lorraine Smith – 11 years
- Peter Stickley – 8 years
- Carl Thorne – 8 years
- Nigel Urban – 8 years
- Hannah Logan-Hughes – 3 years
- Andrew Bramley – 3 years
- Henry Clark – 1 year

I have been compiling these dates from several sources and have tried to be as accurate as possible but apologies in advance if anybody has been missed from this list, if you should have been recognised for a work anniversary please let me know so I can rectify it.

Upcoming Birthdays

Happy Birthday to everybody celebrating in September.

- Andy Poustie
- Ben Burgess
- Bryce Protheroe
- Charlotte Haddow
- Claire Lipscomb
- Ellie Campbell
- Emily Chattaway
- James Hall
- Martin Ecroyd
- Nigel Urban
- Smriti Pun

- Syd Martin
- Tim Dock
- Wilma Scott

miscellaneous

Know Someone Who'd Make a Great Adviser?

FPG are always looking to find new people to join our team, and we know the best people to help grow our network are those already part of it. That's why we're introducing a scheme inviting you to recommend someone you know who'd make a great Mortgage & Protection Adviser. As someone who already shares our values and understands what it means to be part of the FPG network, your referrals are incredibly valuable. As a thank you, you'll receive £500 when your referral signs up, and a further £500 when they achieve competent adviser status. We believe FPG are in a great place to support advisers of nearly any experience in their careers and hopefully as someone already part of the network you would agree, if you have anyone you think might be suitable, please don't hesitate to speak to your Sales Manager.

Upcoming Hangouts

EVERY WEDNESDAY

🕒 1:00PM – 1:30PM (SESSION 1)

🕒 1:30PM – 2:00PM (SESSION 2)

Join us each week for 1 hour of CPD
(2 x 30 minutes) with leading lenders
and insurers.

Finance Planning
Mortgage & Protection

Hangout

1 hour
of CPD



	DATE	SESSION 1 1:00PM – 1:30PM	SESSION 2 1:30PM – 2:00PM
SEPTEMBER			
	9 TH	Joe Tyler HSBC 	Pete Burgess FPG
	16 TH	Clive Moreton Halifax 	Sara Tusher Scottish Widows
	23 RD	Lara Stanley Virgin 	Finnie Patel MetLife
	30 TH	Mike Kerr LV= Enriching lives	Danielle Walters Aldermore



1 HOUR OF CPD. EVERY WEEK.

2 x 30 minute sessions packed with insight,
product updates and support to help you.

Add it to your diary, grab a coffee and join the Hangout!

